THE BLACKHEARTS

PLAYER'S EDITION | A New Recruit's Guide to Blackthorn Hollow

"Out there, you're a criminal. In here, you're a Blackheart. Learn the difference."

Welcome to the Brotherhood

The Blackhearts offer shelter, training, work and protection to thieves, mercenaries, brigands, hunters, smugglers and outcasts. In return they demand loyalty, discipline and the guild's agreed share of earnings. You enter as one of the **Unblooded**; your reputation is yours to make.

1. Blackthorn Hollow

The Broken Crown

Tavern, dining hall, gambling and social hub. Pella Thrice enforces the peace.

The Yard

Sparring circles, archery targets, obstacles and class instruction.

The Counting House

Treasury, loan office, equipment stores, fencing and appraisal.

The Black Table

Restricted council chamber and hearing room.

The Crow's Roost

Courier and intelligence center with cipher records.

The Stitchery

Surgery, medical treatment, rehabilitation; no routine magical healing.

The Burrows

Shared recruit dormitories and better private quarters for veterans.

The Kennels

Horses, hounds, wagons and pack gear.

The Pit

Detention, questioning and internal discipline.

2. The Leaders

Garran Voss — The Old Wolf | High Captain

Patient, disciplined, former military commander. Values competence and secrecy.

Mara Veyne — The Widow | Whispermaster

Quiet, incisive, difficult to deceive.

Bram Harker — Iron Bram | War Captain

Intimidating, disciplined, impatient with caution.

Silas Crowe — Pennygrave | Coinmaster

Polite, precise, remembers every debt.

Elira Thorn — The Briar | Pathwarden

Reserved, resourceful, protective of her scouts.

3. Class Trainers

Hadrik Vale | Fighter

Stern veteran; tactics, weapons, armor. Instruction may require payment, practice or proof of competence.

Nessa Quickfingers | Rogue

Witty and competitive; locks, stealth, deception. Instruction may require payment, practice or proof of competence.

Corvin Ash | Ranger

Taciturn hunter; tracking, survival, Ranger Arts. Instruction may require payment, practice or proof of competence.

Brakka Ironjaw | Barbarian

Fierce and perceptive; endurance, controlled rage. Instruction may require payment, practice or proof of competence.

Brother Caldus | Monk

Severe ascetic; unarmed combat and discipline. Instruction may require payment, practice or proof of competence.

Ranger Arts are unusual disciplines of survival and instinct rather than conventional spellcasting. The Hollow does not provide routine magical healing.

4. Merchants and Specialists

Ordrik Cinderhand | Quartermaster

Exacting dwarf. Services: weapons, armor, equipment and provisions.

Vesper Lark | Chief fence

Elegant and calculating. Services: sale and appraisal of valuables.

Tollin Greaves | Provisioner

Talkative and anxious. Services: food, rations and everyday supplies.

Merek Soot | Blacksmith

Gruff perfectionist. Services: metalwork and repairs.

Della Wren | Forger

Patient, obsessive. Services: documents, seals and false identities.

Ivo Rusk | Locksmith

Nervous inventor. Services: locks, traps and burglary tools.

Gilda Moth | Poisoner

Dry, unsettling herbalist. Services: herbs, toxins and antidotes.

Old Rennick | Stablemaster

Cranky, loves animals. Services: mounts, wagons and animal care.

Pella Thrice | Tavernkeeper

Sharp-tongued, influential. Services: meals, drink, lodging and gambling.

5. Contracts, Intelligence and Care

Tavin Rook | Contract broker

Friendly, organized. Seek this person for contracts and payment arrangements.

Sable Finch | Infiltration specialist

Theatrical, patient. Seek this person for infiltration assignments.

Kerrick Dain | Highway captain

Loud and bold. Seek this person for road and caravan operations.

Ysella Grey | Smuggling chief

Cool, efficient. Seek this person for smuggling work.

Fen Holloway | Scoutmaster

Friendly, observant. Seek this person for reconnaissance and forest routes.

Darric Holt | Guild enforcer

Merciless, disciplined. Seek this person for disciplinary matters.

Wick | Messenger master

Restless, sarcastic. Seek this person for messages and couriers.

Sister Maelin | Chirurgeon

Blunt, highly skilled. Seek this person for surgery and recovery.

Eamon Grist | Gravedigger

Quiet, morbid humor. Seek this person for burials and care of the dead.

6. Rank and Privileges

Unblooded: Probationary recruit; shared rooms and basic contracts.

Brother / Sister: Full membership and standard guild protection.

Blackhand: Trusted veteran with greater opportunities.

Captain: Leader of crews and operations.

Black Table: Five senior leaders who govern the brotherhood.

High Captain: Supreme leader of the Blackhearts.

Promotion depends on successful work, loyalty, reputation and the confidence of officers. Rank brings better contracts and greater responsibility.

7. The Six Laws

• No unauthorized bloodshed within Blackthorn Hollow.

• Do not steal from the brotherhood.

• Pay the guild its agreed share of contract earnings.

• Do not surrender another member to outside authorities without authorization.

• Deliberate betrayal of the brotherhood may be punished by death.

• The Black Table’s judgments are final.

8. Life as an Unblooded

You begin with communal quarters, access to basic training and suitable contracts. Earn respect by completing assignments, protecting companions, paying debts and learning your trade. Not every Blackheart is a friend: rivalry, ambition and personal grudges are part of life in the Hollow.

9. Your Future

A warrior may command a crew; a thief may become a renowned infiltrator; a hunter may uncover hidden routes; a merchant may establish profitable connections. Great success can bring authority and influence, but it also draws attention.

Welcome to the Blackhearts.